INCH-POUND

A-A-55184A
April 21, 2020
SUPERSEDING
A-A-55184
March 10, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BERET, WOOL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for 100 percent (%) wool berets made of a felted knitted material. These berets are intended to be worn by male and female military personnel.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The berets shall be available in the following types, classes, and sizes.

2.1 Types.

I - Unlined with flash
II - Unlined without flash
III - Lined with flash
IV - Lined without flash
V - Lined with flash and nylon tape binding

2.2 Classes.

1– Rifle Green 297 (Army)
2– Blue 1561 (Air Force, Officers)
3– Maroon 1560 (Air Force)
4– Scarlet 1591 (Air Force)
5– Medium Blue 1592 (Air Force)
6– Black 1593 (Air Force)
7– Maroon 453 (Army)
8– Gray 1609 (Air Force)
9 – White 1610 (Air Force)
10 – Black 1593 (Army)
11 – Blue 1561 (Air Force, Enlisted)
12 – Tan 450 (Army)
13 – Slate Gray (JROTC)
14 – Sierra Brown 569 (Security Force Assistance Brigade (SFAB) Army)
15 – Pewter Green 1667 (Air Force)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: DLA Troop Support Standardization Team, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, verify the currency of the address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database https://assist.dla.mil .

AMSC N/A FSC 8405

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release. Distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3 Schedule of sizes.

6-3/8	7	7-5/8
6-1/2	7-1/8	7-3/4
6-5/8	7-1/4	7-7/8
6-3/4	7-3/8	8
6-7/8	7-1/2	

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Description. The beret (see Figure 1) shall be constructed from a one piece knitted wool shell with no visible seams. Types I and II berets shall not be lined and Types III, IV, and V berets shall be fully lined with a polyester/cotton lining material. The beret shall have a felt cushion and binding around bottom opening with a drawcord inserted in binding. The beret shall have a badge stay on the inside of beret. Type I, III, and V shall have a sewn on flash. Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, and 11 shall have two (2) eyelets with a leather eyelet protector (see 3.1.6).

3.1.1 Felt cushion. The beret shell shall have a 3/4 (± 1/8) inch wide felt cushion stitched to the inside bottom raw edge of the blocked shell with the ends of the felt overlapped not more than 1/2-inch using a 502 or 503 stitch type.

3.1.2 Binding. The Types I, II, III, and IV beret shell shall be bound with a leather binding and the Type V beret shell shall be bound with a 1-inch wide nylon binding tape. The ends of the Type V beret nylon binding tape shall be heat cut. The binding shall be stitched 1/16 to 1/8-inch from edge of binding through both the shell and felt cushion and sewn with a 301 stitch type (see 3.2). The leather binding for Types I, II, III, and IV shall be sewn grain side up. The binding ends shall have a 1/2 (± 1/8) inch overlap at seamed edge with a notched opening, toward folded edge, on outside of beret to allow drawcord ends to extend out of binding at center back (± 1/4 inch off center tolerance) of beret (see Figure 2 and 3). The ends of the notched opening shall abut (+ 0, -1/8 inch) together. The binding shall finish smooth and uniform in width.

3.1.3 Drawcord. A drawcord shall be threaded through the binding and shall not be caught in the stitching of the binding and shall move freely through the binding to allow for adjustment. Both ends of the drawcord shall extend beyond the binding opening at center back of beret a minimum of 5-inches and shall be tied in a bow at the back.

3.1.4 Badge stay. The beret shall have a badge stay positioned on the inside of the left front with one end extending 1-inch (±1/4) inch to the right of center front and the bottom edge of the badge stay shall be positioned 3/4 to 7/8-inch from the bottom folded edge of the leather binding on the finished beret. Types I and II beret's badge stay shall be encased in lining material with the bottom edge of the lining material sewn in the stitching of the binding and positioned as specified above. For Types III, IV and V, the badge stay shall be positioned as specified above to the underside of the lining and stitched on all sides (1/8 to 1/4) inch from the edge of badge stay with a 301 stitch type.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.5 Flash. The flash for Types I, III, and V shall be sewn with 301 stitch type to the beret through the shell, lining, and badge stay materials. The flash shall be positioned with the center of the flash centered in the width of the badge stay and positioned with the top corners of the flash abutted to the top edge of the badge stay (see Figure 4).

3.1.6 Eyelet and eyelet protector. The two (2) eyelets for Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, and 11, positioned on the right side of the beret positioned 1(± 1/8) inch apart and centered half way between center front and center back and 1-1/2 (±1/8) inches from bottom edge of beret (see Figure 5). The eyelets shall have a 1 (± 1/8) inch wide by 3 (± 1/4) inches long leather eyelet protector positioned on the inside of the beret stitched on all four sides through all plies with a 301 stitch type. There shall be two (2) holes centered in the eyelet protector and they shall be in alignment with the two (2) eyelets in the beret. The holes in the eyelet protector shall be 1/4 to 5/16-inch in diameter and shall be punched through the eyelet proctor.

3.2 Stitching. All stitching types shall be in accordance with types specified in ASTM D6193. All 301 stitch types shall have 8-12 stitches per inch except for attaching of the leather binding which shall have 6-10 stitches per inch. All 502 and 503 stitch types shall have 6 to 10 stitches per inch. Ends of all 301 stitch types shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1/2-inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams or stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering. The lock stitch shall be imbedded in the materials sewn. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a maximum length of 1/4-inch.

3.3 Materials.

3.3.1 Basic material. The shell material for the berets shall be knit from 100 percent (%) woolen yarn consisting of 64's grade (average fiber diameter, 20.60 to 22.04 microns with a 5.19 maximum standard deviation) or finer blended wool. The shell shall be knit on a flat or circular reciprocating beret machine with 9 or 10 needles per inch. The knitted shell shall undergo a felting and dyeing process. The shell shall be mothproofed in accordance with MIL-C-43665, except that the requirements for special markings shall not apply. The berets shall be blocked to size, to conform to finished measurements specified in Table V, and shall be shaped and sheared to a smooth finish. All loose fibers shall be removed. The finished shell material shall conform to the requirements specified in Table I when tested as specified in Table I.

THIS SPACE LEFT INTENTIONALLY BLANK

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Shell requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Wool Content (dry weight) (minimum)	95 % Wool	AATCC TM20A (see 7.4)
Wool Grade (minimum)	64's	ASTM D3991
Colorfastness to: (minimum)		
Light	3	AATCC TM16.3, Option 3 1/, 2/
Perspiration	3	AATCC TM15 3/
Water	3	AATCC TM107 3/
Wet Dry Cleaning	3	AATCC TM132 3/
Crocking (Wet and Dry)	1.5	AATCC TM8 4/
Weight, ounces per square yard	18.0 - 22.0	ASTM D3776/D3776M
Bursting Strength, pounds (minimum)	45	ASTM D3787
Stiffness, cm. (Bending length)	2.0 - 5.0	ASTM D1388, Option A

1/ After 40 AATCC Fading Units (AFU) or 170 kJ/ (m^2nm)@420 nm
2/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Color Change
3/ Rated using the AATCC EP1, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Color Change and AATCC EP2, Evaluation Procedure for Gray Scale for Staining.
4/ Rated using the AATCC EP8, Evaluation Procedure for 9-Step Chromatic Transference Scale

3.3.1.1 Basic material visual shade matching. The color and appearance of the finished beret shall match the standard sample for shade for the class specified when viewed using the AATCC EP9, Option C (see 7.7), with sources simulating artificial daylight D75 illuminant with a color temperature of 7500K (± 200) illumination of 100 (±20) foot candles, and shall be a good match to the standard sample under incandescent A illuminant with a color temperature of 2856 (± 200)K. Each of shells of the sample unit (see paragraph 5.3) shall be tested as specified above. The test specimen shall be one (1) shell. Failure of one (1) or more shells to match the standard sample shall be considered a test failure.

3.3.2 Felt cushion. The wool felt cushion shall be a minimum of 45 percent (%) wool yarn consisting of 48's grade or finer blended wool. The finished wool felt cushion shall conform the requirements specified in Table Ia when tested as specified in Table Ia. The color shall be gray.

TABLE Ia. Felt requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Wool Content (dry weight) (minimum)	45 % Wool	AATCC TM20A (see 7.4)
Wool Grade (minimum)	48's	ASTM D3991
Weight, ounces per square yard	6.0 (± 0.25)	ASTM D3776/D3776M
Breaking strength, pounds (minimum)	8	ASTM D5034
Thickness	0.065 (± 0.01)	ASTM D1777

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.3 Leather. The leather for the binding Type I, II, II and IV and eyelet protector (Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 15 as applicable) shall be full grain, vegetable tanned sheepskin or bovine that has been re-tanned so as to have perspiration resistance. The grain side of the leather shall have a medium luster, skiver grain embossed finish. The leather shall be drum dyed to match Black 111. The leather shall be in conformance to the requirements listed in Table II when tested by the methods in Table II.

3.3.3.1 Cracking. At least 80 percent of the leather binding specimens shall not crack when tested as specified in 3.3.3.1.1.

3.3.3.1.1 Cracking test method. One (1) 4 x 1-inch leather specimen shall be tested from each 8 x 8-inch sample unit. The specimen shall be folded upon itself in the lengthwise direction, grain side out. The folded specimen shall be folded upon itself again at right angles to the first fold. Examine the specimen along the folds and report any evidence of cracking. The fingers and thumbs shall be positioned 1/2-inch to 1-inch from the apex of the fold when test specimen is tested.

TABLE II. Leather requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Thickness, ounces	2 to 2-1/2 1/	ASTM D1814
Shrinkage Temperature (minimum)	185°F (85°C)	ASTM D6076
Blocking,	At least 80 % shall separate with ease and shall show no grain	ASTM D6116
Colorfastness to: (minimum) Crocking : Dry Wet	 4 4	 ASTM D5053 2/ ASTM D5053 2/
Staining (minimum)	4	ASTM D6012 2/
Area stability of leather to: perspiration	At least 80% shall have an area loss no greater than	ASTM D2322
Ash (moisture free), % (maximum)	5.0	ASTM D2617
pH (minimum)	3.3	ASTM D2810
Chromic oxide (moisture free), % (maximum)	0.5	ASTM D2807
Stitch Tear Strength, lbs. (minimum)	12	ASTM D4705
Oil/Grease content, % (maximum)	25	ASTM D3495

1/ As an alternate for the eyelet protectors only, the leather may be 1.5 to 2.0 ounces
2/ Stain matching shall be done in indirect light and rated using the AATCC EP8, Evaluation Procedure for 9-Step Chromatic Transference Scale

3.3.3.2 Tape. The tape for the Type V beret's binding shall be a nylon, plain weave, non-critical use (shuttle or shuttleless loom), nylon 66, and 1 (±1/32) inch in width. The color of the tape shall be black.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.4 Eyelets. The eyelets for the Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, and 11, shall be brass or aluminum and shall have a black enamel finish. The diameter of the barrel shall be 0.250 (±0.015) inch and the length under the head shall be 0.156 (± 0.015) inch.

3.3.5 Drawcord. The drawcord shall be a nylon or polypropylene flat braid, 5/16-inch wide having 64 ends of 300 denier continuous filament nylon and shall conform to the requirements in Table III when tested as specified in Table III. As an alternate the braid may have 33 ends of 420 denier continuous filament nylon. The color shall be black.

TABLE III. Drawcord requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Colorfastness to: Wet Drycleaning (minimum)	4	AATCC TM132
Width	5/16 (±1/16)-inch	Visual
Ends (per braid)	64	ASTM D3775

3.3.6 Badge stay. The badge stay shall be medium density, water resistant, latex resin-inorganic filler compound saturated needle punch polyester nonwoven. The thickness of the polyester non-woven shall be 0.072 (± 0.003) when tested in accordance with ASTM D1777. The color of the finished badge stay shall be natural (tan). The badge stay shall not curl, nor show any sign of separation. The badge stay shall not shrink more than 1.5 percent in any direction when tested in accordance with AATCC TM135, (3)(V)(D).

3.3.6.1 Water resistance. The badge stay shall be tested for water resistance as follows: A drop of distilled water shall be placed on the surface of the badge stay board and shall not be completely absorbed in 1 hour. Three determinations shall be made per sample unit (see 5.3) and the results reported as “pass” or “fail”.

3.3.7 Flash (Types I, III, and V). The flash shall be in accordance with the requirements specified in the contract or purchase order or they shall be provided as Government furnished materials. The Classes 2, 11, and 13 beret shall have a flash in accordance with the following drawings (see Figures 6, 7, and 8).

For Class 2: - Drawing: Air Force Security Forces - Officer Number A-4-174
For Class 11: - Drawing: Air Force Security Forces - Officer Number A-4-173
For Class 13: - Drawing: Institute of Heraldry - Officer Number A-4-269

3.3.8 Lining material. The material for lining the Types III, IV, and V, berets and for encasing the badge stay for Types I and II shall be polyester and cotton conforming to Class 1 of A-A-52106. The cloth shall be dyed black.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.9 Thread. The thread shall conform to Type I (cotton-covered) or Type II (polyester-covered) polyester core, Tex 36-45 of A-A-50199. As an alternate Type I, Tex 50 or 60 conforming to A-A-52094 may be used. The thread color shall be black except that the needle thread color for stitching the flash to the beret (Types I and III) shall be a good match to the flash background color.

3.4 Labels. The beret shall have a combination identification/instruction/size label positioned 1-inch off center back and caught in the stitching of the binding. It shall include a barcode label/tag, and a paper care instruction note.

3.4.1 Identification/instruction/size label. Each beret shall have a white, commercial type, combination identification/instruction/size label sewn into the stitching of the binding positioned 1-inch from the center back of beret on the inside. The label's inscription shall have a minimum font size of 10 points, and shall show "good" colorfastness to wet dry cleaning when tested in accordance with AATCC TM132. The label shall include the following information:

Beret, Wool Size: 6-7/8 (example) 100% Wool Stock No.: 8405-00-000-0000 (example) Name of Contractor: Contract No.: SPO100-00-0-000 (example) Dry Clean Only

3.4.2 Label/tag. Each beret shall be individually bar-coded with a paper tag for personal clothing items. The paper used for the tags shall be standard bleached sulfate having a basis weight of 100 pounds with a smooth finish to accept thermal transfer and direct printing. The tags shall have a hole and shall be attached to each item by a fastener. The bar-code shall be clearly legible and readable by scanner. The bar coding element shall be a 13 digit national stock number (NSN). There shall be a 12 digit Universal Product Code (UPC) assigned for all NSNs by the Government. The initials "UPC" must appear beneath the code. The bar codes for NSN and UPC shall be a medium to high density and shall be located so that they are completely visible on the beret when it is packaged as specified. The label's location shall cause no damage to the beret.

3.4.2.1 Care instruction note.. Each beret shall have a white, commercial type, printed paper note enclosed with each beret with the following information:

Brush the hat regularly to remove loose soil and lint slightly dampen a clean cloth. Wipe the beret in short, directional strokes working from one side of the beret to the other side. Allow the beret to dry completely before wearing it.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Patterns. The Government will furnish the graded pattern for the lining and the pattern for the badge stay. The pattern generally provides for a seam allowance of 1/4-inch. The Government patterns may be used to create the contractor's working patterns, however the design and measurements of the patterns shall not be altered in any way, with the exception of minor modifications to accommodate automation.

3.5.1 Pattern parts. The pattern parts for lining the beret Types III, IV, and V, and pattern part for badge stay lining for Types I and II, and the pattern part for the badge stay for all beret types shall be cut from the materials specified in accordance with pattern parts and cut quantity specified in Table IV.

TABLE IV. List of pattern parts.

Material	Nomenclature	Abbreviation	Cut parts
Lining	Crown, Types III, IV, and V	CROWN_LIN	1
	Body, Types III, IV, and V	BODY_LIN	2
	Crown interlining, Types III, IV, and V	CRWN_INTLN	1
	Badge stay lining, Types I and II	STAY_POCKET	2
Badge stay	Badge stay, all types	BADGE_STAY	1

3.6 Finished measurements. The beret shall conform to the measurements specified in Table V.

TABLE V. Finished measurements (in inches).

SIZE	Circumference A/	Crown Length B/	Crown Width C/	Front Quarter D/	Back Quarter E/	Right and Left Quarter F/
6-3/8	20-1/8	9-5/8	9-1/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
6-1/2	20-1/2	9-3/4	9-1/4	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
6-5/8	20-7/8	9-7/8	9-3/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
6-3/4	21-1/4	10	9-1/2	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
6-7/8	21-5/8	10-1/8	9-5/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7	22	10-1/4	9-3/4	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-1/8	22-3/8	10-3/8	9-7/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-1/4	22-3/4	10-1/2	10	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-3/8	23-1/8	10-5/8	10-1/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-1/2	23-1/2	10-3/4	10-1/4	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-5/8	23-7/8	10-7/8	10-3/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-3/4	24-1/4	11	10-1/2	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
7-7/8	24-5/8	11-1/8	10-5/8	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
8	25	11-1/4	10-3/4	3	2-1/2	2-3/4
Tolerance	±3/16	±1/2	±3/8	N/A	N/A	N/A

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

A/ Circumference: Lay the beret flat on the table with head opening facing up. Measure inside beret's circumference around bottom folded edge of binding on the finished beret.
B/ Crown Length: Mark the front and back quarter locations in accordance with instructions in footnote D/. Lay the beret flat on the table with head opening facing down. Measure from Front Quarter mark to Back Quarter mark following the contour of the beret. Crown length is indicated by "B" in Figure 1.
C/ Crown Width: Mark the Right and Left quarter locations in accordance with instructions in footnote D/. Lay beret flat on the table with head opening facing down. Measure from Left Quarter mark to Right Quarter mark following the contour of the beret. Crown width (perpendicular to the length measurement) is indicated by "C" in Figure 1.
D/ Front, Back, Right and Left Quarters: Identify location of each Quarter as indicated in Figure 1; Front Quarter is indicated by "D", Back Quarter is indicated by "E" and Right and Left Quarters are indicated by "F". Measure the length from Table V of each quarter from folded edge of binding. Mark the finished location of each quarter with a straight pin.

NOTE: All measurements shall be taken using a flexible metal tape measure and all measurements shall be taken after all packaging material has been removed.

3.7 Figures. Figures are furnished for information purposes only. When inconsistencies exist between the written commercial item description and the figures, the written commercial item description shall govern.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished beret shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the contractor's own quality assurance standards and the quality assurance standards defined by the technical data in the bid package.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Visual and dimensional examination. Each beret shall be examined for visual and dimensional defects which affect the appearance, material, workmanship, and marking. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality levels cited in the contract or purchase order and shall be in accordance with the sampling procedures cited in ASQ/ANSI Z1.4. Each beret shall be examined for the defects as listed in Table VI.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Defects.

EXAMINATION	DEFECTS
Material and Workmanship	Component part omitted, not cut as specified, distorted, full, tight, or twisted; any part of beret caught in any unrelated row of stitching. Hole, cut, tear, burn, run, thin place, dye streak, color not as specified, knot Or slub, mend or darn, foreign matter caught in knitting. Damage to beret or binding, seam allowance not as specified, raw edge, end of stitching not backtacked or backtacked less than 1/2-inch when not caught in another row of stitching. Loose stitch tension 1/2-inch or more in length, or tight tension resulting in stitches breaking when normal tension is applied. Gauge of stitching uneven or not as specified or varying more than 1/16-inch. Skipped or run-off stitches, broken stitches, seam and or stitch type not as specified, stitches per inch not as specified. Blocking omitted . Shearing omitted. Beret does not have a smooth finish . Any component not in accordance with specified requirement. Any finished dimension not in accordance with Table V.
Binding	Twisted, puckered, or pleated; binding not abutted at center back or overlapping. Not specified material. Nylon binding tape not heat cut as specified.
Drawcord	Drawcord caught in stitching of binding, drawcord not tied in a bow, not specified material, not specified length.
Badge Stay	Not positioned as specified, caught in the stitching of the binding.
Lining (Types III, IV and V)	Not securely caught in stitching, omitted.
Leather (Types I, II, III, and IV)	Not full grain, any hole, cut, tear, or rupture, brand mark, healed grub hole, scar tissue, hip mark, brittle or bony area, abrasion, scratch, or other grain damage. Excessively flanky, spongy, pipey, or stretchy leather. Binding not full grain leather. Made from corrected or embossed grain leather.
Eyelet (Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, and 11	Color of finish other than specified, scratched, split or cracked. Out of horizontal alignment by 1/8-inch, one or both eyelets set less than 1-3/8 inches or more than 1-5/8 inches from bottom edge of beret, less than 7/8-inch or more than 1-1/8 inches apart. Not centered between center front and center back by more than 1/2-inch.
Shade	Shade variation within a part. Shell, thread, leather, or drawcord color not as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Examination of defects. - Continued

EXAMINATION	DEFECTS
Cleanness	Spot, stain, thread ends not trimmed or removed. Rancid odor.
Labels	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, misplaced, contains a hole, not attached as specified, or stitched through printing. Bar-codes not scannable or readable by scanner; human readable interpretation (HRI) omitted or illegible; bar code not visible on folded, packaged item; bar code causes damage to the
Flash (Types I, III and V)	Omitted, incorrect type, not positioned as specified, damaged, not in accordance with requirements.
Packaging	Any item not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Component and material inspection. The materials and components of the beret shall conform to the requirements cited in this commercial item description. The lot shall be unacceptable if one (1) or more sample units fail to meet any of the test requirements specified. The lot size expression and the sample size shall be in accordance with the following:

Component	Lot size expressed as	Sample unit for testing
Shell	Shells	12 Shells
Badge stay	Pounds	3 Square yards
Braid	Yards	1 Yard

5.4 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. PACKAGING. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.8).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of Government documents.

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.2 Sources of non-Government documents

7.2.1 AATCC test methods are available online at https://www.aatcc.org.

7.2.3 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://www.asq.org.

7.2.2 ASTM Standards are available online at https://www.astm.org.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.3 Intended use. This beret is intended to worn by male and female military personnel.

7.4 Certificate of compliance. The contracting activity may select to accept a certificate of compliance for stated requirement.

7.5 Standard samples. For access to standard shade samples of cloth, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

7.6 Superseding documents. This Commercial Item Description document incorporated all technical data specified in Purchase description CR-PD PD-01-09 dated July 30, 2001. In addition, all interim changes to the CR changes to the CR-PD-01-09, addition of classes 10 to 15, and change to Beret's use to a unisex item were also incorporated. This document was pervious called “Beret, Man’s, Wool”, under A-A-55184. The A revision end item document removed the word “Man’s” as it is now a unisex item.

7.7 Visual shade matching. In 2019, Option A of AATCC EP9, Evaluation Procedure for Visual Assessment of Color Difference of Textiles was changed to Option C. NOTE: In case of confusion, the viewing geometry should be “The specimen plane and illumination source shall be parallel to each other and aligned so that the light flux is incident at the center of the specimen plane, which is set at a 35 (± 5º) angle relative to the horizontal. The observer shall view the specimens at a 90º angle, relative to the plane of the specimens”.

7.8 Ordering data. The contract or purchase order should specify the following:

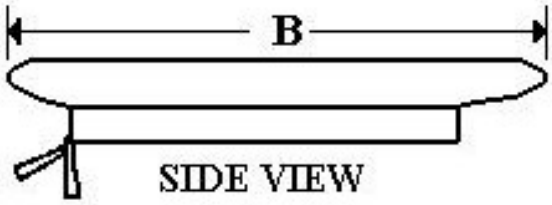
a. Title, number, and date of this document
b. Types, Classes and Sizes required (see 2)
c. Labeling information (see 3.4)
d. Regulatory requirements (see 4)
e. Product conformance provisions (see 5)
f. Packaging requirements (see 6)

7.9 Subject terms.

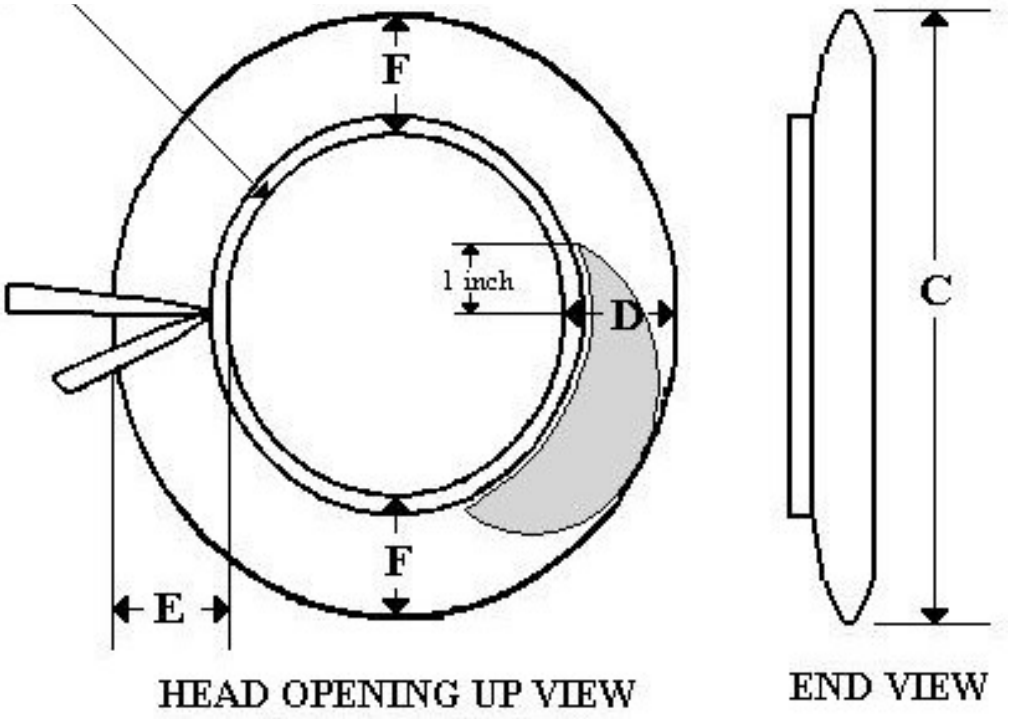
Badge Stay
Clothing
Flash
Headwear

THIS SPACE LEFT INTENTIONALLY BLANK

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



A - AROUND BOTTOM FOLDED EDGE OF BINDING



- Badge Stay Placement
- A - Circumference
- B - Crown Length
- C - Crown Width
- D - Front Quarter
- E - Back Quarter
- F - Right and Left Quarters

FIGURE 1. Beret, Wool.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

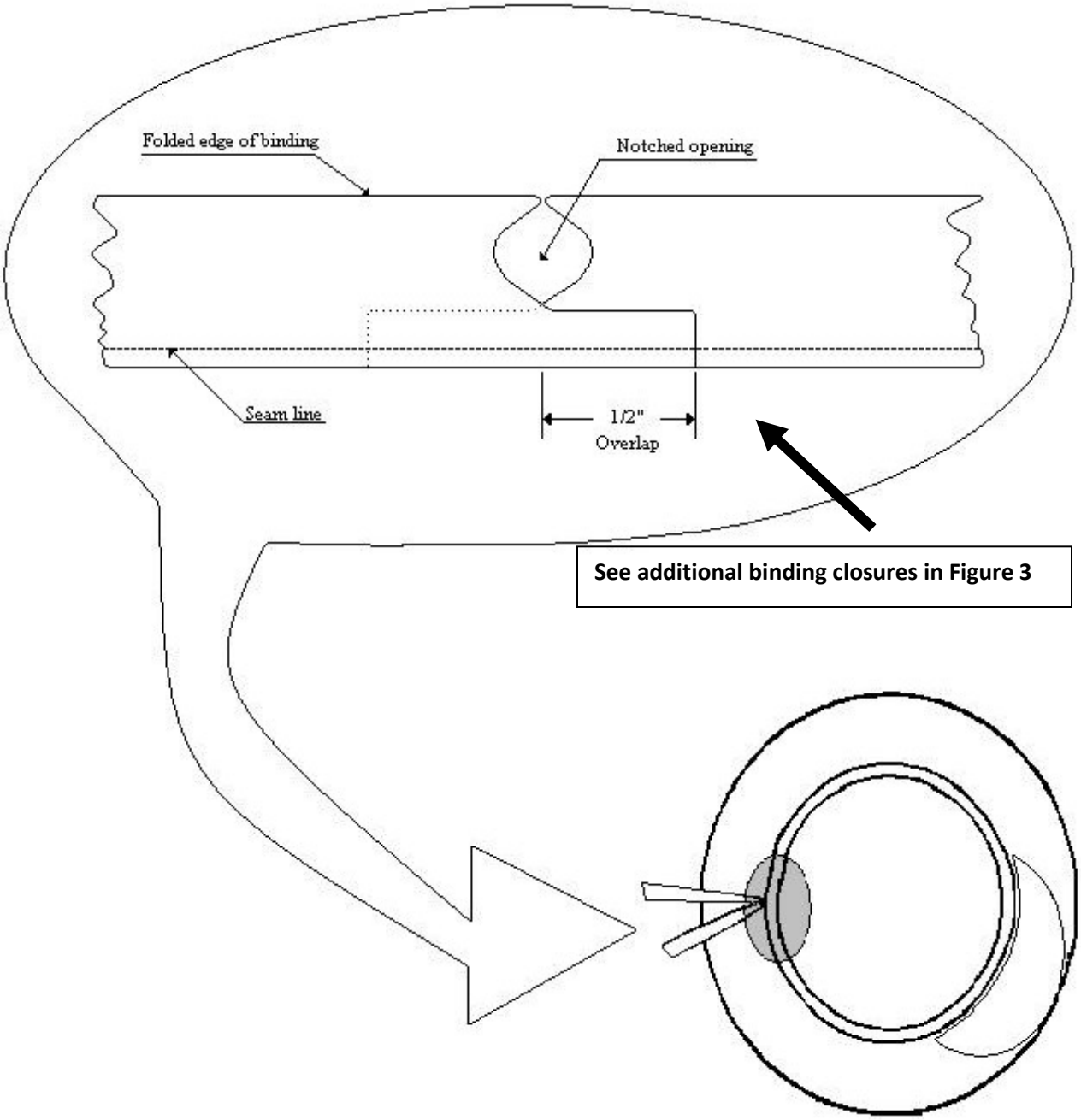


FIGURE 2. Close up of binding closure.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

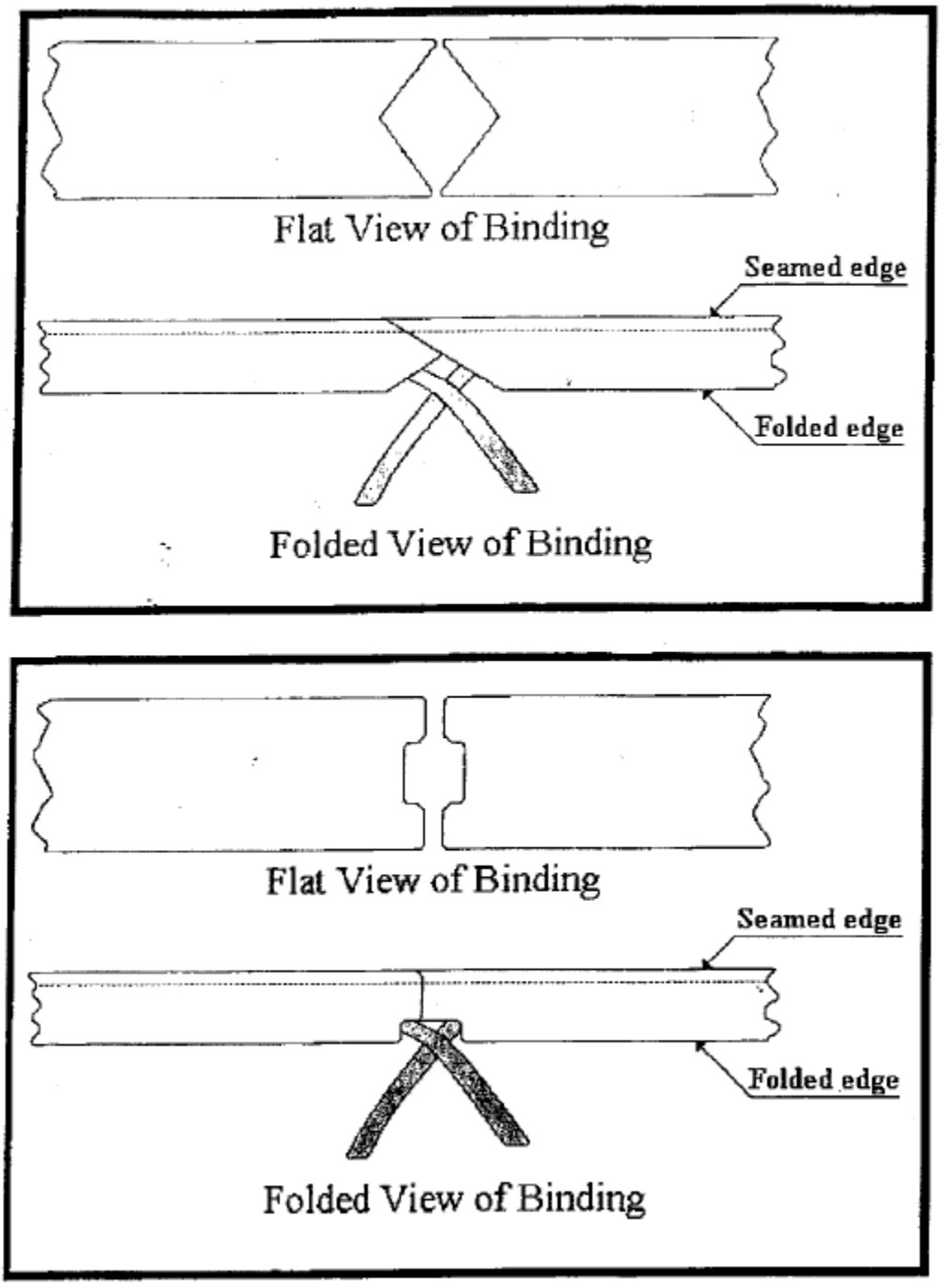


FIGURE 3. Close up of additional acceptable binding closures.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

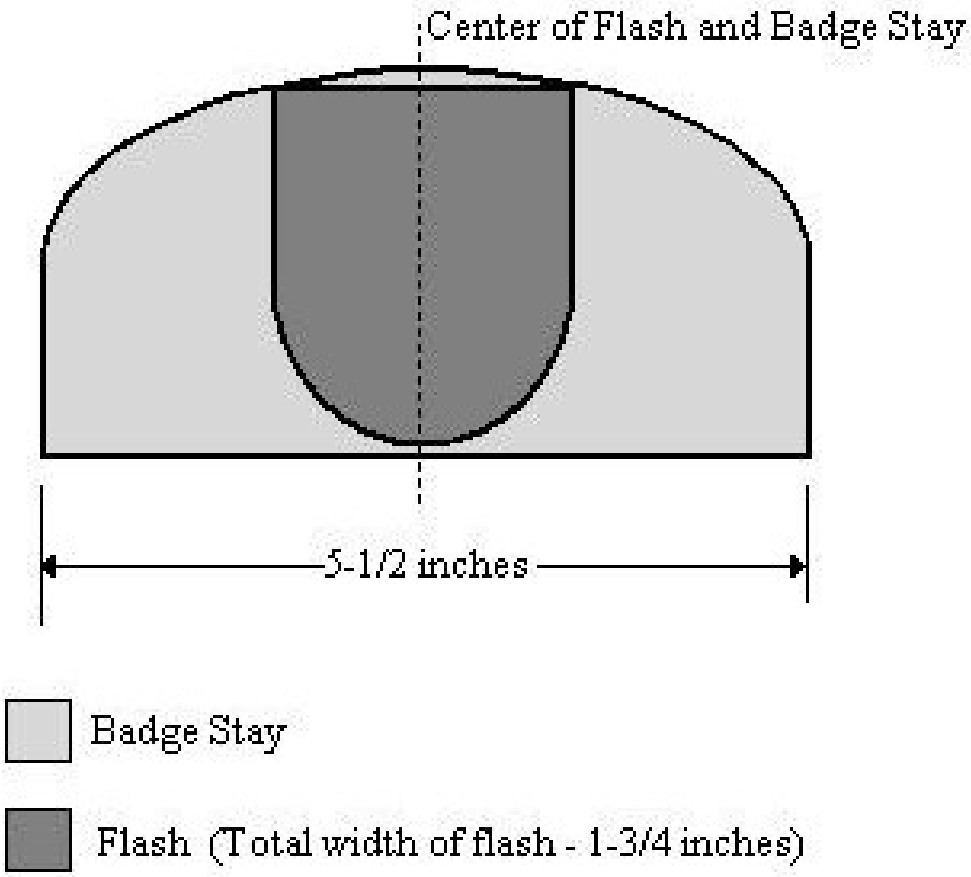


FIGURE 4. Badge stay with flash placement.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

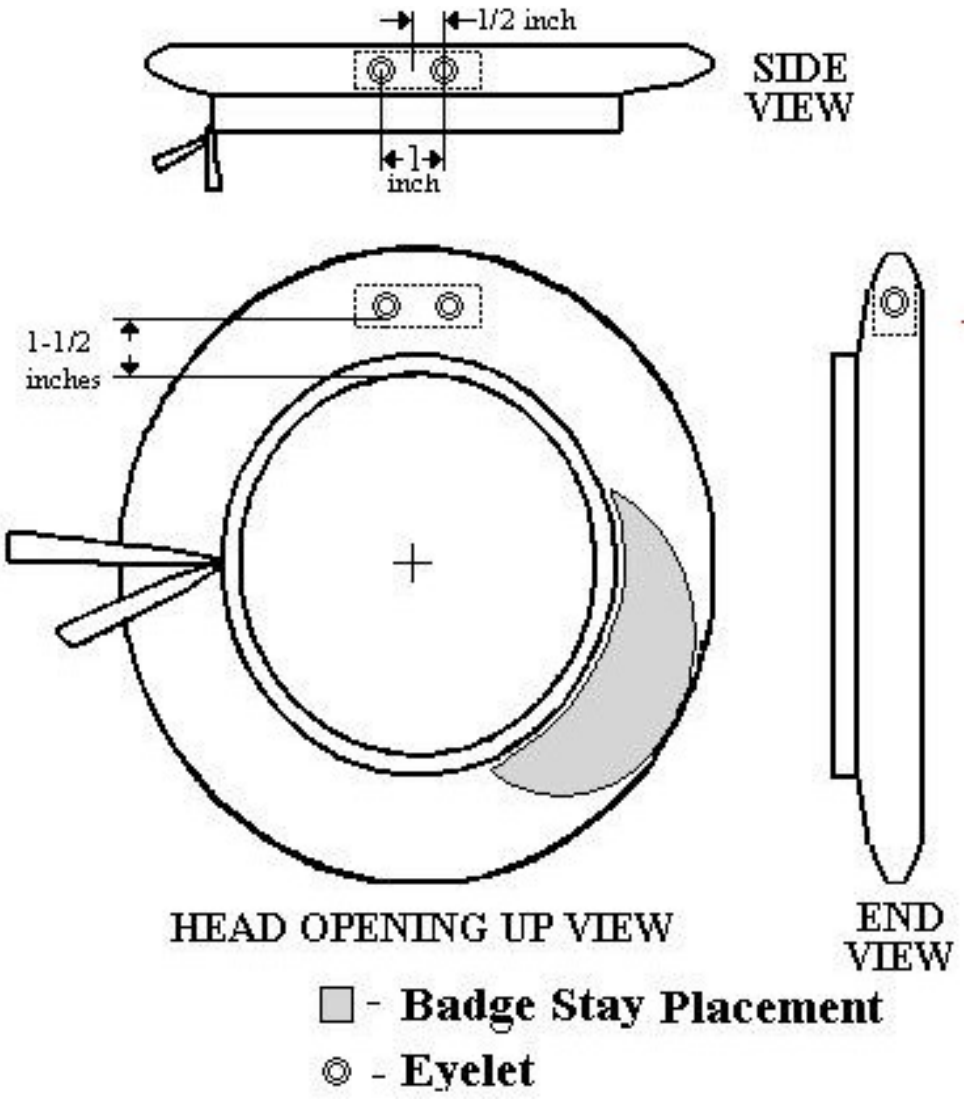
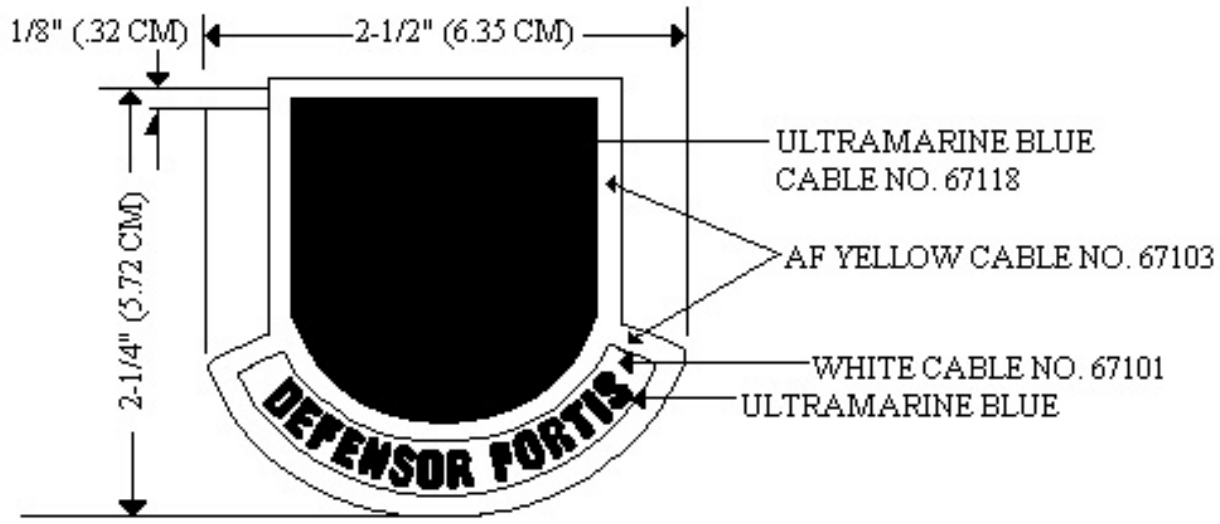


FIGURE 5. Eyelet position for Classes 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 9, and 11.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



DESIGNED FOR OVEREDGE STITCHING

SUBDUED NOTES BORDERS AND LETTERS TO BE BLACK CABLE NO. 67138
SCROLL TO BE OLIVE DRAB CABLE NO. 67133

COLOR CONVERSION OF SHIELD
ULTRAMARINE BLUE TO BE- FLAG BLUE CABLE NO.67124

4289 STITCHES (MINIMUM)
100/2 DENIER
12/4 SPAN

Materials to be manufactured in accordance with MIL-DTL-14652

(Illustration of Drawing A-4-174)

AIR FORCE SECURITY FORCES - OFFICER

FIGURE 6. Flash for Beret (Class 2) - Air Force Officers

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



DESIGNED FOR OVEREDGE STITCHING

SUBDUED NOTES BORDERS AND LETTERS TO BE BLACK CABLE NO. 67138
SCROLL TO BE OLIVE DRAB CABLE NO. 67133

COLOR CONVERSION OF SHIELD
ULTRAMARINE BLUE TO BE - FLAG BLUE CABLE NO.67124
AF YELLOW TO BE – SPRUCE GREEN CABLE NO. 67130
SILVER GRAY TO BE – SPRUCE GREEN CABLE NO. 67130
WHITE TO BE – OLIVE DRAB CABLE NO 67133

5874 STITCHES (MINIMUM)
100/2 DENIER
12/4 SPAN

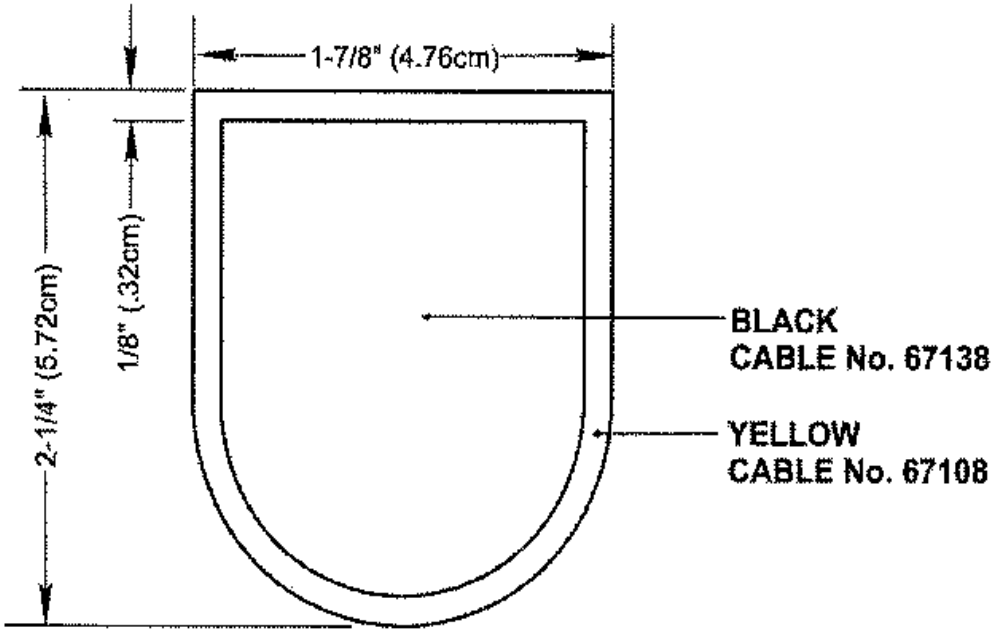
Materials to be manufactured in accordance with MIL-DTL-14652

(Illustration of Drawing A-4-173)

AIR FORCE SECURITY FORCES – ENLISTED

FIGURE 7. Flash for Beret (Class 11) - Air Force Enlisted.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



DESIGNED FOR OVEREDGE STITCHING
3467 STITCHES (MINIMUM)
90/2 DENIER
8/4 SPAN

(Illustration of Drawing A-4-269)

FIGURE 8. Flash for Beret (Class 13) – Army JROTC.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY
GSA-FAS

Custodians:
Army - GL
Air Force - 11

Preparing Activity:
DLA - CT

(Project: 8405-2020-005)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.